



Delaware County Commissioners Meeting August 2nd 2021

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1diG5e8rv9s
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Delaware County Commissioners Meeting Report

Meeting Date: August 2, 2021

Meeting Time: 9:01 AM

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the Delaware County Commissioners meeting to order on Monday, August 2, 2021, at 9:01 AM.
- **Attendance:**
 - Present: Mr. Henry, Ms. Reagan, and Mr. King (Presiding Officer).
 - Absent: None noted.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Approval of Minutes:** The minutes of the July 19, 2021 commissioners meeting were approved.

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:01:01 Appointments to the Civic Center Authority Board**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board Commissioners
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board considered three interested candidates for the Civic Center Authority Board.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Mr. Henry, Ms. Reagan, Mr. King voting aye).
- **00:01:30 Muncie Public Library Board Appointment**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board Commissioners
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Consideration of appointing/reappointing Denise King to the Muncie Public Library Board.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Mr. Henry, Ms. Reagan, Mr. King voting aye).
- **00:01:52 Maintenance Supervisor Position / Recognition**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Pam McCammon / Board Commissioners
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board recognized outgoing Maintenance Supervisor Charlie for 26 years of service and running multiple county buildings. A farewell celebration was announced for Friday from 11:00 AM to 1:00 PM on the plaza. Following an interview process conducted by Commissioners and staff with 4 applicants, Steven Foster was selected for the role.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Stephen Foster appointed as Maintenance Supervisor. Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:05:42 Table Business: Ordinance Number 2021-025**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board Commissioners / Legal Counsel
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Commissioners requested to keep the ordinance tabled until the next meeting.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Tabled.
- **00:06:23 Contracts / Agreements: Thompson's Subdivision Plat Approval**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ashton, Land Surveyor
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presentation and review of the subdivision plat approval.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:07:20 Rejection of INDOT Offer for Temporary Easement County Road Repairs**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** John / Highway Department
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussed county road repairs necessitated by an unofficial detour during work on State Road 28. The county's cost estimate exceeded \$300,000, whereas INDOT offered a settlement of \$50,000. Commissioners agreed to formally reject INDOT's offer and issue a demand for actual repair costs.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote to reject the INDOT offer and demand actual costs.
- **00:08:26 Ordinance Number 2021-026 (First Reading)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** John (Legal Counsel) / Commissioners

- **Deliberation Summary:** An ordinance to limit weight and commercial truck traffic on Delaware County roads, introduced to address semi-trucks diverting off state highways onto county roads unequipped for heavy constant traffic. Introduced for initial discussion and future revision.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced and Approved by Voice Vote for first reading.
- **00:09:42 Resolution Number 2021-031**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** John / Pam McCammon
 - **Deliberation Summary:** A resolution rescinding the separate Delaware County Public Safety Employees Handbook and Highway Bridge Engineering Employee Manual. To ensure consistency and unified discipline, employees will transition fully under the standard county handbook.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:28:42 Payment of Claims**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board Commissioners
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Review of claims totaling \$4,106,986.97.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- *(Note: No individual members of the public spoke during the formal public comment period near the conclusion of the meeting, though departmental updates were provided by emergency services, highway representatives, and economic development staff).*

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff & Board Announcements:**
 - **00:11:02 Emergency Services / Software Upgrade:** Paul provided an update on the Tyler software upgrade affecting the 911 dispatch, sheriff's department, new jail, and city services. Due to severe staffing shortages (losing 3 personnel in 10 days) and an aggressive schedule, Paul recommended pausing the scheduled October "go-live" date to focus on completing the build and testing properly. Commissioners concurred.
 - **00:14:33 Highway & Traffic Safety Updates:** Bobby Dougherty reported ongoing safety and accident issues at the 300 South and State Road 35 intersection, exacerbated by bypass closures. Planned safety improvements include upgraded double stop signs (36-to-48 inch), flashing beacons, placement closer to the intersection, and striping. Long-term road widening and drainage considerations were also noted.

- **00:20:42 EMS Update:** Megan Coutinho, EMS administrator and EMT, was recognized for stepping out of the office to work shifts on the ambulance truck.
- **00:21:15 Public Safety Compensation & ARPA Discussion:** Commissioner King addressed public inquiries regarding public safety raises and American Rescue Plan Act (ARPA) funds. It was clarified that ARPA funds cannot legally be used for staff raises, personnel, or retirement (restricted to COVID-19 related expenses and infrastructure like water, sewer, broadband, and stormwater). Brad, Director of Economic Development, spoke on county tax base growth outside Muncie limits. Commissioners emphasized that while they strongly support raises for underpaid public safety and corrections officers, salary increases are the jurisdictional authority of the County Council, not the Commissioners.
- **00:29:35 AR Plan Update:** Mentioned that the county's AR plan is still undergoing adjustments to ensure strict compliance before final review.
- **Adjournment:**
 - **Action:** Motion to recess/adjourn approved by voice vote.

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